

Clinderma Customer Support Chatbot

Problem Statement & Phased Roadmap — VIT Student Project

Prepared for: VIT Student Project Team

Prepared by: Ankit - Chief of Staff & Head of Tech, Clinderma

Date: July 2026

Project type: Build from scratch - full ownership of design, architecture, and implementation

1. About Clinderma

Clinderma is a D2C, dermatologist-led skincare brand in India, personalised product recommendations, and dermatologist consultations. Support today runs across calls and WhatsApp. This project adds a chatbot layer, starting on the website.

2. Objective

- Handle FAQs and general customer queries automatically.
- Hand off to a human agent whenever the bot cannot resolve a query.
- Collect the customer's phone number during the conversation and pass it to the CRM (Kylas).
- If an answer isn't found in the knowledge base, the bot must say so - it should never guess or fabricate an answer.

3. Channels

The bot will be built for three channels, rolled out in priority order:

Priority	Channel	Notes
1 (build first)	Website	Chat widget on the Clinderma website
2	Instagram	Integrated after the website version is working
2	WhatsApp	Integrated after the website version is working

4. Availability & Language

- Languages: Hindi, English, and Marathi.
- The chatbot should NOT appear on the skin assessment form - it must not interrupt or interfere with that flow.

5. Knowledge Base

The bot's answers should be grounded in three content sources:

- FAQs — common customer questions and answers.
- Product Module — product names, prices, usage instructions, and plan details.
- Website Content — general brand, policy, and informational content from the site.

If a query isn't covered by these sources, the bot falls back to "no answer found" and hands it off to a human rather than improvising.

6. Build Roadmap (Phased)

The bot is built in phases of increasing capability. Each phase should be a working, demoable milestone before moving to the next.

Phase	Milestone	What it covers
Phase 1	Normal Chatbot	Handles FAQs using the knowledge base (website only)
Phase 2	Personalised Chatbot	Responses adapt to the customer/context rather than being generic
Phase 3	Order Tracking + Call Routing	Handles order tracking queries and routes calls/leads to the Skin Coach
Phase 4	Final Version	Handles escalation to humans and is trained on Clinderma's internal data
Phase 5	Instagram Integration	Same bot logic extended to Instagram DMs
Phase 6	WhatsApp Integration	Same bot logic extended to WhatsApp

7. Core Behaviours (apply across all phases)

- Answer only from the knowledge base (FAQs, Product Module, Website Content) - say "I don't have that information" rather than guessing when nothing matches.
- Escalate/hand off to a human agent whenever the bot can't resolve the query, with the conversation context carried over.
- Stay out of the skin assessment form flow entirely.
- Do not make false promises for the treatment

8. What Clinderma Will Provide

- FAQ list, product catalog, and website content for the knowledge base.
- Sample order data to build and test order-tracking (Phase 3).
- Anonymised internal data for training the final version (Phase 4).

9. Deliverables

- Working chatbot for each phase, demoed before moving to the next.
- Source code with a README (setup, architecture, key decisions).
- Documentation of the knowledge base structure and the escalation/handoff logic.
- Final demo covering all phases, including Instagram and WhatsApp integration.

10. Point of Contact

Ankit, Chief of Staff - Tech & Product, Clinderma - for weekly check-ins, content/data access, and clarifications on requirements.